



TORNADO CHEAT SHEET

Core setup, initialization, operations & integration quick reference

PART 1: SETUP & CORE

01. SETUP & APPLICATION

Installation

```
pip install tornado
import tornado.web, tornado.ioloop
app = tornado.web.Application([
    (r'/hello', HelloHandler),
    (r'/ws', WebSocketHandler),
])
app.listen(8888)
tornado.ioloop.IOLoop.current().start()
```

04. ASYNC HANDLERS

Workflow

```
class AsyncHandler(tornado.web.RequestHandler...
    async def get(self):
        result = await some_async_function()
        self.write({'result': result})
# HTTP fetch:
http = tornado.httpclient.AsyncHTTPClient()
response = await http.fetch('http://example.c...
```

02. REQUEST HANDLERS

Architecture

```
class MainHandler(tornado.web.RequestHandler):
    async def get(self):
        name = self.get_argument('name', 'World')
        self.write(f'Hello {name}')
    async def post(self):
        data = tornado.escape.json_decode(self.request.body)
        self.set_status(201)
        self.write(data)
```

05. WEBSOCKETS

CRUD API

```
class ChatHandler(tornado.websocket.WebSocketHandler):
    def open(self):
        clients.add(self)
    def on_message(self, msg):
        for c in clients: c.write_message(msg)
    def on_close(self):
        clients.discard(self)
# JS: ws = new WebSocket('ws://host/ws')
```

03. ROUTING

YAML / Config

```
app = tornado.web.Application([
    (r '/', MainHandler),
    (r '/users/(?P<user_id>[0-9]+)', UserHandler),
    (r '/static/(.*)', tornado.web.StaticFileHandler),
    {'path': 'static'},
])
```

URL patterns are regexes; groups become positional args

06. TEMPLATES

Integration

```
class PageHandler(tornado.web.RequestHandler):
    def get(self):
        self.render('index.html', title='Hi', items=[...])
# index.html:
{% for item in items %}{{ item }}{% end %}
{{ escape(user_input) }}
```

Auto-escaping enabled by default



SECURITY, MONITORING & OPERATIONS

Production hardening, observability, performance tuning & CLI reference

PART 2: OPS & SECURITY

07. REQUEST & RESPONSE

Hardening

```
self.request.method / .headers / .body
self.get_argument('key', default=None)
self.get_body_argument('key')
self.request.files['file'][0]['body']
self.set_header('Content-Type', 'application/...
self.set_status(200)
self.write(json.dumps(data))
```

10. ERROR HANDLING

Unit Tests

```
def write_error(self, status_code, **kwargs):
    self.write({'error': self._reason})
    raise tornado.web.HTTPError(404, 'Not found')
    raise tornado.web.Finish() # stop handler, n...
# Unhandled exceptions return 500
```

08. COOKIES & SESSIONS

Observability

```
self.set_cookie('user_id', str(user.id), http...
self.get_cookie('user_id')
# Secure signed cookie:
self.set_secure_cookie('user_id', str(user.id...
self.get_secure_cookie('user_id')
cookie_secret='random-secret-key' in Applicat...
```

11. TESTING

Commands

```
from tornado.testing import AsyncHTTPTestCase
class Test(AsyncHTTPTestCase):
    def get_app(self): return app
    def test_get(self):
        resp = self.fetch('/hello')
        self.assertEqual(resp.code, 200)
        self.assertIn(b'Hello', resp.body)
```

09. IOLOOP BASICS

Optimization

```
loop = tornado.ioloop.IOLoop.current()
loop.run_sync(main_coroutine)
# Periodic callback:
cb = tornado.ioloop.PeriodicCallback(check, 5...
cb.start()
# Schedule once:
loop.call_later(30, one_time_task)
```

Single-threaded event loop; never block the loop

12. COMMON GOTCHAS

Warning

Blocking I/O in handlers stalls all requests
Use `run_on_executor` for CPU-bound code
`WebSocket check_origin()` returns `False` by default for XSS
Exceptions in callbacks must be handled or they're swallowed
Don't use `time.sleep()` use `asyncio.sleep()`